

ENGINEERING

IIT-Kanpur takes the crown pipping other IITs, while four new entrants into the toppers try to play catch up

TOP 10 COLLEGES

2007		2006
▲	1 IIT-Kanpur	2
▼	2 IIT-Delhi	1
▲	3 IIT-Chennai	5
▼	4 IIT-Mumbai	3
▼	5 IIT-Kharagpur	4
▼	6 IIT-Roorkee	6
★	7 IIT-Guwahati	11
★	8 IIIT, Allahabad	-
★	9 College of Engineering, Anna University, Chennai	12
★	10 National Institute of Technology, Trichy	13

National rankings are derived from a combination of perceptual and factual scores. Colleges that did not provide factual information were not ranked. ★: New entrants in Top 10. (→) Not ranked in the 2006 Top 20.

■ By Kalf Mahmood in Kanpur

Hum thode se tedhe hain (we are a little quirky)." That's how Sanjay Dhande, director, Indian Institute of Technology (IIT)-Kanpur, explains why the engineering college is No. 1 in the country. Not surprisingly, the seven IITs hold the top seven ranks in this year's survey of best colleges, with IIT-Guwahati making a comeback to the top 10 list after failing to make it in 2006. The Indian Institute of Information Technology, Allahabad, and National Institute of Technology, Tiruchirappalli, are the other new entrants.

The institute has always been

thinking out-of-the-box. It was the first to introduce a pure-science-based education for engineering students at a time when other institutes were concentrating on field trips and applied sciences. It was founding director P.K. Kelkar who envisaged that the innovators of the future need to be creative thinkers with strong fundamentals in the pure sciences. Met with scepticism in the beginning, the programme was later adopted by the other IITs. "To be inventive, you need to work outside the conventional framework," explains Dhande.

Students and faculty at IIT-K are not surprised at its top ranking. The institute has constantly been the choice of more than half of the top

100 rankers at the Joint Entrance Examination, owing largely to its computer science department, reputed to be the best in the country. While its prowess as a teaching institute is unchallenged, the institute is aiming to become one of the world's top research institutes as well. With an annual budget of Rs 85 crore, IIT-K constantly endeavours to improve its reputation. One such effort is the SAMTEL Centre for Display Technologies, the first of its kind in the country working on path-breaking technologies to make display screens sophisticated and cost-effective.

There has been a revolution in the infrastructure and research activities in the campus. This includes an addi-

